

The Importance of 1:1 Meetings/ Check Ins

One-on-one (1:1) meetings are a cornerstone of effective management and employee engagement. The purpose of these check-ins is to provide feedback and discuss goals and expectations. They are also a time when you and your manager will talk about your career goals and what professional development opportunities you would like to pursue.

The quarterly check-ins are an essential tool for both you and your manager to ensure your success in your position. During your quarterly check-ins, you should expect to receive feedback on whether you met the expectations as well as constructive feedback on where there might be room for improvement and guidance on how to better meet those expectations.

These quarterly check-ins are also an opportunity for you to share feedback with your manager. You may choose to share:

- What you feel is going well.
- What barriers you may be experiencing in your work.
- What additional supports you may need.
- Progress on any of your development goals.

Monitoring

During the periods between quarterly check-ins, your manager will observe your work and evaluate your adherence to expectations and any progress you have made toward the goals previously set.

You should expect regular, informal check-ins with your manager to stay in touch on your work and how things are going. How often these occur will depend on your current workload, how the work is progressing, and what support you need. If you are a new employee or in a new role, you should expect more frequent check-ins with your manager during your probationary period to ensure that feedback and performance expectations are being provided during your onboarding and training period.

Remember to make notes of accomplishments, challenges, and progress on your work and/or projects so you can discuss them with your manager during your check-ins.

Communicating with your manager throughout the 12-month cycle is an important aspect of the feedback process. If you aren't having enough one-on-one meetings with your manager or need additional support or guidance outside of the quarterly check-in meetings, you should request more frequent meetings or schedule something with your

manager. The performance process is an active and engaging process - proactively participating will give you the best results.

The 12-month feedback cycle is as follows.

Monitoring & Observing Performance	Conduct & Document Check-ins By
<i>The manager will monitor and observe performance during these months.</i>	<i>The manager to hold the check-in meetings and document them by...</i>
January – March	End of April
April – June	End of July
July – September	End of October
October – December	End of January

Questions Staff Members Can Ask Their Manager

Career growth and personal development

- What steps can I take right now to progress my career with the organization?
- What mentorship opportunities are there available for me?
- Who in the organization do you think I can learn the most from?
- Who are your mentors? Who inspires you?
- Where do you see my role evolving in the next 6 months and 1 year?
- What learning and development opportunities are there within and outside of the organization?
- What's a skill you think of I can learn that will help me do a better job?
- What skills do you think our team is lacking?
- How can I help train and support others in the team and organization

Communication and feedback

- What's something you feel unclear about on my work?
- How am I doing with this project/new initiative?
- When's the best time to get feedback on my work?
- Do you feel like I'm a team player? Do I collaborate well?
- Do you think I contribute enough in team meetings?

- What soft skills do you think I excel at most? What is my area of opportunity?
- What's an example of a situation I've handled well/ poorly?
- Where do you think my communication can be improved?
- Am I giving enough feedback to my peers?

Key priorities, individual and team productivity, and overall strategy

- What can I do to help improve team productivity?
- What's something you wish we did better as a team?
- What's something we do well as a team?
- How are we progressing on our goals as a team?
- How can we improve the way our team collaborates?
- What initiative do you wish I took more ownership over?

Supporting your manager and managing up

- How can I better support you?
- What's worrying you most?
- What are your biggest challenges leading the team?
- What are you most excited about in your day-to-day?
- What's your biggest challenge as a people leader?
- Is there anything I can do more or less of that would help you?
- What do you do to avoid burnout?